

# CUSTOMER SUPPORT POLICY

Service Standards, Escalation Procedures & Resolution Guidelines

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## 1. Introduction

ShopEase Pvt Ltd ('ShopEase', 'we', 'us') is committed to providing every customer with timely, fair, and effective support across all stages of the shopping journey — from pre-purchase enquiries through post-delivery resolution. This Customer Support Policy ('Policy') defines the service standards, response timelines, escalation paths, and resolution frameworks that govern all customer interactions on the ShopEase platform (web and mobile). By using ShopEase services, the customer ('you', 'the Buyer') agrees to the terms outlined herein. ShopEase reserves the right to amend this Policy; the version in effect at the time of the interaction shall apply.

## 2. Key Definitions

- Support Ticket:** A unique, system-generated case record (Ticket ID: CS-XXXXXXXXXX) created upon submission of a customer query or complaint through any official ShopEase channel.
- First Response Time (FRT):** The time elapsed between ticket creation and the first substantive reply from a ShopEase support agent or automated resolution system.
- Resolution Time (RT):** The total time from ticket creation to the closure of the issue, including any investigation, logistics, or third-party coordination required.
- Standard Order:** Any single-transaction purchase of 1–9 units of the same SKU placed by an individual buyer account.
- Bulk Order:** A purchase of 10 or more units of the same SKU, or any order whose pre-tax value exceeds ₹50,000, within a single transaction.
- Tier-1 Support:** Front-line agents handling general queries, order tracking, and standard complaints via chat, email, or phone.
- Tier-2 Support:** Specialist agents handling escalated or complex cases including bulk order disputes, fraud investigations, and unresolved Tier-1 issues.
- Grievance Officer:** A designated senior official responsible for final-stage complaint resolution as mandated under the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020.

## 3. Support Channels, Hours & Response SLAs

| Channel           | Access Point                     | Availability             | First Response Time                 |
|-------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| In-App / Web Chat | Help > Chat with Us              | 24 × 7                   | < 3 minutes (bot); < 10 min (agent) |
| Email             | support@shopease.in              | 24 × 7 (monitored)       | Within 12 hours                     |
| Phone Helpline    | 1800-XXX-XXXX (Toll-Free)        | Mon–Sat, 9 AM – 9 PM IST | < 5 minutes average wait            |
| Callback Request  | Help > Request a Callback        | Mon–Sat, 9 AM – 8 PM IST | Within 2 hours of request           |
| Grievance Officer | grievance@shopease.in            | Business days only       | Within 48 hours                     |
| Social Media DMs  | @ShopEaseSupport (Twitter/X, FB) | Mon–Sat, 9 AM – 6 PM IST | Within 4 hours                      |

All support interactions are logged and assigned a Ticket ID. Customers should retain this ID for follow-ups and escalations. Social media DMs are for general queries only; sensitive account or payment information must never be shared on public social channels.

## 4. Scenario-Specific Support Guidelines

### 4.1 Standard Orders

- Customers may raise queries related to order status, payment confirmation, invoice requests, or product information at any time after order placement.

- Order modification requests (change of address, quantity, or variant) are accepted only **before the order is dispatched**. Post-dispatch modifications are not possible; customers must wait for delivery and initiate a return if required.
- Cancellation requests for standard orders are accepted up to **2 hours after order placement** or before dispatch, whichever is earlier. Cancellations after dispatch follow the Refund Policy (SE-POL-RF-2025-07).
- Duplicate order queries (same item ordered twice within 30 minutes) are flagged automatically; customers should contact support within **1 hour** of placement for a no-penalty cancellation.
- Invoice and GST certificate requests are fulfilled within **24 hours** via email from invoice@shopease.in.

## 4.2 Bulk Orders

- Bulk order customers are assigned a **dedicated Relationship Manager (RM)** for the duration of the order lifecycle. RM contact details are shared via email within 4 business hours of order confirmation.
- All bulk order support queries must be routed through the assigned RM or the bulk support email: bulksupport@shopease.in. Standard chat and phone channels handle bulk queries at Tier-1 only and will escalate to the RM team.
- Bulk order cancellation requests are evaluated case-by-case. Cancellations within **12 hours of placement** incur no penalty. Cancellations between 12–48 hours may attract a 5% processing fee on the order value. Cancellations after 48 hours or post-dispatch are not accepted.
- Bulk order dispute resolution (short shipment, quality variance, pricing discrepancy) has a dedicated RT of **7–10 business days**, compared to 3–5 days for standard orders.
- Supporting documentation (purchase order, GST registration certificate, authorisation letter) may be requested by the RM team for disputes exceeding **₹1,00,000** in value.

## 4.3 Damaged Items

- Damage complaints for ShopEase-Fulfilled Orders (SFOs) must be submitted within **48 hours of delivery** with photographic or video evidence via 'My Orders > Report a Problem'.
- Damage complaints for Seller-Fulfilled Orders (SeFOs) must be submitted within **72 hours of delivery**. ShopEase mediates between buyer and seller; if the seller does not acknowledge the complaint within **5 business days**, ShopEase assumes liability.
- Upon claim approval, a replacement shipment is dispatched within **3 business days (SFO)** or **5 business days (SeFO)**. Customers who prefer a refund over replacement may indicate this preference at the time of complaint submission.
- Customers who refuse to provide photographic/video evidence will have their claim reviewed solely on the basis of carrier scan data and may receive a delayed resolution of up to **10 business days**.
- Repeat damage claims (3 or more within a 180-day period) on the same account will trigger a mandatory Tier-2 fraud review before resolution is processed.

## 4.4 Delayed Delivery

- Customers may raise a delay complaint if their order has not been delivered within **2 calendar days past the Estimated Delivery Date (EDD)** shown at checkout.
- For SFOs delayed by **3–6 days past EDD**: a **₹75 ShopEase Voucher** is issued automatically; no support ticket is required.
- For SFOs delayed by **7 or more days past EDD**: a lost-shipment investigation is opened automatically. The customer is notified and offered a choice of replacement or full refund, resolved within **7 business days**.
- Delay complaints for SeFOs are forwarded to the seller within **24 hours**. If no seller update is received within **3 business days**, ShopEase escalates and processes a refund within **5 business days**.
- Delays caused by incorrect address, failed delivery attempts (customer unavailability), or force majeure events are not eligible for voucher compensation. Support agents will assist in rescheduling delivery in such cases.

## 5. Resolution Timelines by Issue Type

| Issue Category                 | Support Tier | Target Resolution Time    | Escalation Trigger           |
|--------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------|------------------------------|
| Order tracking / status update | Tier-1       | Same interaction / < 1 hr | If tracking stalled > 48 hrs |

| Issue Category                    | Support Tier | Target Resolution Time  | Escalation Trigger            |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Invoice / GST certificate request | Tier-1       | Within 24 hours         | If not received in 24 hrs     |
| Standard order cancellation       | Tier-1       | Within 2 hours          | If within cancellation window |
| Standard order damage claim       | Tier-1       | 3–5 business days       | If unresolved in 5 days       |
| Standard order delay complaint    | Tier-1       | 3–7 business days       | If unresolved in 7 days       |
| Payment failure / double charge   | Tier-2       | 2–3 business days       | Immediate on contact          |
| Bulk order dispute                | Tier-2       | 7–10 business days      | If unresolved in 10 days      |
| Account suspension / access issue | Tier-2       | 3–5 business days       | Immediate on contact          |
| Fraud / unauthorised transaction  | Tier-2       | 1–2 business days       | Immediate on contact          |
| Grievance Officer escalation      | Tier-3       | Within 15 business days | Mandated by law               |

## 6. Escalation Framework

- **Level 1 – Tier-1 Support:** All initial contacts. Resolved via chat, email, or phone within stated SLAs.
- **Level 2 – Tier-2 Specialist:** Triggered automatically if a Tier-1 ticket is unresolved beyond the target RT, or immediately for payment fraud, account issues, and bulk order disputes. Customers may also request a Tier-2 escalation directly.
- **Level 3 – Grievance Officer:** Available to customers whose complaint remains unresolved after Tier-2 review. Written request to [grievance@shopease.in](mailto:grievance@shopease.in) with Ticket ID required. Mandatory 15-business-day resolution under Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020.
- **External Redressal:** Customers unsatisfied with the Grievance Officer's decision may approach the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (NCDRC) or the applicable State Commission as per the Consumer Protection Act, 2019.

*Note: Escalating directly to Level 3 without completing Level 1 and Level 2 review may delay resolution, as the Grievance Officer will refer the matter back to the appropriate tier for documentation.*

## 7. Exceptions & Non-Eligible Cases

- Support requests submitted through unofficial channels (personal email addresses of agents, social media comments, third-party forums) will not be acknowledged or tracked.
- Complaints raised beyond the stipulated window (e.g., damage claims after 48/72 hours, delay claims after order is marked delivered + 15 days) may be declined at ShopEase's discretion.
- Accounts flagged for policy abuse (fraudulent returns, chargeback misuse, fake damage claims) will have support interactions routed to Tier-2 review regardless of issue type, with a mandatory response time of up to 10 business days.
- ShopEase support agents are not authorised to offer compensation, discounts, or resolutions beyond those defined in this Policy and the linked Refund Policy (SE-POL-RF-2025-07) and Shipping Policy (SE-POL-SH-2025-04). Promises made outside official documented channels are not binding.
- Support for orders placed through third-party resellers or offline ShopEase partner stores is the responsibility of the respective seller; ShopEase will assist in facilitating communication only.
- Product usage guidance, technical troubleshooting for third-party products, and warranty claims for manufacturer-defective items are handled by the brand/manufacturer; ShopEase support will provide referral details only.

## 8. Customer Conduct & Rights

- ShopEase is committed to treating all customers with respect and expects the same in return. Abusive, threatening, or discriminatory behaviour toward support staff will result in immediate termination of the interaction and may lead to account suspension.
- Customers have the right to request a transcript of any chat or call interaction within **30 days** of the interaction date by emailing [support@shopease.in](mailto:support@shopease.in).

- Customers may opt out of post-interaction satisfaction surveys at any time; this does not affect the quality or priority of future support.
- All personal data shared during support interactions is governed by the ShopEase Privacy Policy (SE-POL-PV-2025-01) and applicable data protection laws.

9. Contact Support

| Channel         | Details                   | Best For                | Availability       |
|-----------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|
| In-App Chat     | Help > Chat with Us       | Quick queries, tracking | 24 × 7             |
| Email – General | support@shopease.in       | Documentation, invoices | 24 × 7             |
| Email – Bulk    | bulksupport@shopease.in   | Bulk order issues       | Mon–Sat, 9 AM–6 PM |
| Phone           | 1800-XXX-XXXX (Toll-Free) | Urgent issues, payments | Mon–Sat, 9 AM–9 PM |
| Callback        | Help > Request a Callback | Scheduled conversations | Mon–Sat, 9 AM–8 PM |
| Grievance Ofcr. | grievance@shopease.in     | Unresolved escalations  | Business days only |

When contacting support, please have the following ready for faster resolution: Order ID, registered email address or mobile number, Ticket ID (for follow-ups), and any supporting evidence (photos, screenshots, order confirmation email). This helps our team resolve your issue in the shortest possible time.